

APPIAN INTERVIEW EXPERIENCE

Role: Software Engineer

The interview process consisted of four rounds.

Online Coding Round:

Three coding questions were asked. The questions were same for everyone, including those in the summer internship drive as well.

1. Breadcrumbs in a website – Given a list of lists of string of paths to webpages in a website, generate the navigation tree and return the root node.
2. There is a line consisting of people from different groups. We need to rearrange the line so that people from the same group can stand together. If all the persons who belong to the same group stand in line, then the names of the persons can be replaced with the group name. The order of the groups in the line and the order of persons within the group in the line should not change.
3. There are n people waiting in line to buy tickets to a Taylor Swift concert. The ticket manager starts at an offset position m and distributes the first ticket. Then, the manager jumps k steps in a cyclic fashion to give the next ticket, and this process continues until all tickets are distributed. The task is to determine the order in which tickets are given out.

This sum is derived from the Josephus sum.

Most of the students who solved all three questions got shortlisted for the interviews.

Technical Interview – 1:

The interview started with a brief introduction about myself. Then the interviewer asked about the basics of OOPS and had me explain how data structures like stacks, queues, and trees have real-world applications. I gave a few examples, such as a management hierarchy for a tree. After that, he asked me [this](#) puzzle. He then asked me to solve the [Two Sum](#) problem and run the code for a few test cases. Finally, he asked me about how a web server and DNS work. The interview ended with a few questions from my side.

Technical Interview – 2:

After a brief introduction about myself, the interviewer read through my resume and asked some questions about my skills. He then asked me to explain one of my projects. Once I had given him the explanation, he asked a few follow-up questions and wanted me to describe some challenges I faced during that project. He also asked about my summer internship experience and the work I did there. Then he asked whether I would join their company even if I received a PPO from my internship company. I replied that, as per CUIC policy, I should accept the first offer I receive. Finally, the interviewer gave me a chance to ask him a few questions.

Interview – 3:

It was more of a casual conversation. He asked about my HSC and college scores and how I learned the things I mentioned in my resume. He also asked about some YouTube channels I had followed to learn those topics. He asked similar questions about my summer internship, just like in my previous interview. Toward the end, I asked him a few questions, and the interview lasted for around 15 minutes.

Key Takeaways:

- The coding questions were mostly based on arrays.
- Follow C.O.D.E resources. It will help you to get an idea about various types of problems in each topic. And I followed takeUForward YouTube channel for the topics like Binary Search, Graphs, Trees and DP.
- Go through commonly asked puzzles available on GeeksforGeeks.
- Be thorough with your resume and the projects you have included.
- Be prepared with the basics of DBMS, OS, OOPS, and Networks.
- Initially, for any DSA question, you can give the brute force approach and then tell how you can optimize that. While coding, ensure you effectively communicate your thought process to the interviewer.
- Learn about the company before the interview, and ask questions when you can.

All the very best.

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